

IT Equipment Policy

Document ID: IT-POL-007 | Version: 3.0 | Effective Date: March 1, 2024 | Owner: IT Department

1. Purpose

This policy defines the rules governing the provision, use, maintenance, and return of IT equipment issued to employees and contractors. It aims to protect company data, ensure equipment longevity, and maintain a secure technology environment.

2. Standard Equipment Provision

Upon joining, employees receive a standard equipment bundle based on their role:

Role	Standard Equipment Bundle
Office Employee	Laptop, docking station, monitor, keyboard, mouse, headset
Developer / Engineer	High-performance laptop, dual monitors, mechanical keyboard, webcam, USB-C hub
Executive / Director	Premium laptop, portable monitor, noise-cancelling headset, wireless peripherals
Field / Remote Employee	Laptop, portable charger, travel mouse, 4G hotspot device
Intern / Contractor	Laptop only (no peripherals unless approved by manager)

3. Acceptable Use

Company IT equipment must be used primarily for legitimate business purposes. Limited personal use is permitted provided it does not:

- Interfere with the employee's work duties or performance
- Consume excessive bandwidth (e.g., streaming large personal files)
- Violate any law or company policy
- Compromise the security of company systems or data
- Result in installation of unauthorized or unlicensed software

4. Prohibited Activities

The following activities are strictly prohibited on company IT equipment:

- Accessing, downloading, or sharing illegal, offensive, or pornographic content
- Installing cryptocurrency mining software or engaging in personal financial trading
- Circumventing security controls (e.g., disabling antivirus, using unauthorized VPNs)
- Sharing login credentials or allowing unauthorized persons to use company devices

- Attempting to access systems or data beyond the scope of your role

5. Security Requirements

All employees must:

- Enable full-disk encryption (BitLocker/FileVault) on all company laptops
- Use a screen lock with a timeout of no more than 5 minutes of inactivity
- Keep the OS and all software up to date; critical patches must be applied within 48 hours
- Connect to public Wi-Fi only through the company-approved VPN
- Report any suspected security incident (malware, phishing, unauthorized access) to IT immediately

6. Equipment Care & Damage

Employees are responsible for the reasonable care of all issued equipment. Accidental damage must be reported to IT within 24 hours. Repair or replacement costs for negligent damage may be partially or fully borne by the employee. Theft must be reported to both IT and the police within 4 hours of discovery.

7. Return of Equipment

All IT equipment must be returned to IT within 3 business days of: resignation, termination, role change not requiring the equipment, or extended leave of more than 60 days. Equipment returned in poor condition beyond normal wear and tear may result in a charge against the employee's final paycheck.